THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 09

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 40 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one factual passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one literary passage (poem or story) with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

Catching Every Drop: Rainwater Harvesting

Rajasthan has always known the value of water. For centuries, its people have built stepwells, tankas and johads to catch the rain that falls in the short monsoon and keep it for the dry months. Today, as cities grow and groundwater sinks lower every year, this old wisdom is returning in a new form called rainwater harvesting.

Rainwater harvesting means collecting the rain that falls on roofs and open ground instead of letting it run off into drains. In a typical house, rainwater is led from the roof through pipes into a filter and then into an underground tank or into a recharge pit, where it slowly seeps into the earth and refills the groundwater. In this way the water that would have flooded the street is saved for use later.

The advantages are many. First, harvested water can be used for washing, gardening and cleaning, thus reducing the demand on the municipal supply. Second, it raises the level of the water table, so that wells and hand pumps do not go dry in summer. Third, it reduces waterlogging and flooding during heavy showers. The cost of installing a system is small compared with the savings over the years, and in several cities the law now requires new buildings above a certain size to have one.

A school can set an excellent example. A group of students can measure the roof area, calculate how much rain it can collect in a year and design a simple tank with the help of a teacher. Such a project teaches mathematics, science and responsibility at the same time. As the old saying goes, 'A drop saved is a drop earned', and a little effort by each of us can add up to a large reserve for the future.

(i) Rajasthan's traditional methods of saving water include: 1

(a) water towers **(b)** dams and canals
(c) stepwells, tankas and johads **(d)** tube-wells

(ii) In rainwater harvesting, water from the roof flows first into: 1

(a) the road **(b)** a well **(c)** a river **(d)** a filter

(iii) Harvesting rainwater raises the: 1

(a) demand for water **(b)** price of water
(c) water table **(d)** temperature

(iv) The word 'seeps' in paragraph 2 means: 1

(a) flows slowly through **(b)** jumps
(c) freezes **(d)** boils

(v) Which of the following is NOT an advantage mentioned? 1

(a) It makes the water sweeter **(b)** It reduces demand on the supply
(c) It keeps wells from drying up **(d)** It reduces waterlogging

(vi) State whether True or False: Rainwater harvesting is a completely new idea in Rajasthan. Correct if false. 1

(vii) Name two uses of harvested water. 1

(viii) What is a recharge pit meant to do? 1

(ix) How can a school students' project help in learning? 1

(x) What does the saying 'A drop saved is a drop earned' mean? 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Literary Passage — Poem / Story) 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

The Teacher's Umbrella

Rain was falling in sheets on the morning of the annual exam. Little Pooja stood at the gate of the village school, her book bag wrapped in a plastic sheet, and shivered. She had walked four kilometres through the mud and her slippers were soaked.

The school clerk looked at her and said, "You are late. The paper began ten minutes ago." Pooja's heart sank. She had worked hard for three months and now she might not be allowed in. At that moment the headmistress, Mrs Rao, came out of her office with a large black umbrella in her hand.

"Why are you standing here?" she asked. Pooja explained that the stream near her home had overflowed and she had to take the long road round. Mrs Rao listened without a word. Then she opened her umbrella, held it over the girl and led her to the examination room. "Rules are made to be followed," she told the clerk, "but they are also made for children. She is here now. Give her the paper and ten extra minutes."

Pooja wrote till her fingers ached. When the bell rang she handed in her paper with a feeling of quiet joy. Mrs Rao was waiting outside with a cup of hot milk. "Whatever your result, I want you to know that I saw how far you came," she said.

Years later, when Pooja became a teacher herself, she kept a black umbrella in her classroom. Whenever a student arrived late and wet, she would hold it open and say, "Come in. We shall manage."

(i) Pooja was late because: 1

(a) she lost her book **(b)** the stream had overflowed
(c) the bus broke down **(d)** she woke up late

(ii) The headmistress's name was: 1

(a) Mrs Iyer **(b)** Mrs Rao **(c)** Mrs Sharma **(d)** Mrs Verma

(iii) Mrs Rao allowed Pooja to write the exam and gave her: 1

(a) ten extra minutes **(b)** a new pen
(c) a prize **(d)** a holiday

(iv) 'Rules are made for children' means that rules should: 1

(a) be strict always **(b)** be applied with understanding and kindness
(c) be ignored **(d)** be written for children only

(v) Pooja kept an umbrella in her classroom as a: 1

(a) decoration **(b)** weapon
(c) reminder of Mrs Rao's kindness **(d)** gift to students

(vi) State whether True or False: Pooja lived next door to the school. Correct if false. 1

(vii) How did Pooja protect her books from the rain? 1

(viii) What did the school clerk say to Pooja? 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage that means 'trembled with cold'. 1

(x) What lesson do you learn from Mrs Rao's behaviour? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

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